

45. (a) Reluctant means unwilling and hesitant. So, 'disinclined' is its synonym.
46. (a) Intricate is 'complicated'.
47. (c) Penury is the state of being very poor. So, 'poverty' is its synonym.
48. (d) Expostulate means to express strong disapproval or disagreement. Hence, 'argue' is its synonym.
49. (a) Absurd means extremely silly, foolish or unreasonable. So, 'senseless' is its synonym.
50. (a) Philanthropy is the practice of giving money and time to help make life better for other people. So, 'generosity' is its synonym.
51. (d) To traipse means 'to walk or move wearily or reluctantly'.
52. (c) The quality of 'being very generous' is called as Munificence.
53. (b) 'Decorate' is synonymous with Embellish.
54. (a) Bask means 'to lie exposed to warmth and light'.
55. (a) Skittish means 'nervous or excitable'.
56. (b) Seamless means 'smooth and continuous'.
57. (a) Iniquitous means grossly unfair and morally wrong. So, 'sinful' is its synonym.
58. (c) Implode is 'collapse or cause to collapse violently inwards'.
59. (d) Impugn is to call into question. So, 'challenge' is its synonym.
60. (c) Banquet stands 'for an elaborate and formal evening meal for many people'.
61. (d) Pulverise means 'to reduce to fine particles'.
62. (d) Bucolic is relating to the pleasant aspects of the country side and country life. So, 'rural' would be its synonym.
63. (a) To snare is to 'trap'.
64. (b) Littoral is 'relating to or situated on the shore of the sea or a lake'.
65. (c) 'A busy, noisy situation' is called as hubbub.
66. (d) 'To address someone boldly or aggressively' is called as Accost.
67. (b) Beguiling is 'charming or enchanting', often in a deceptive way.
68. (b) 'Salivating' is the synonym of slobber.
69. (c) Gregarious means 'sociable'.
70. (a) A reply, especially a witty one is called as a Rejoinder.
71. (b) A person who informs on a person or organisation as engaging in an unlawful or immoral activity is called a Whistle-blower.
72. (a) 'A portion of something, especially money' is called as Tranche.
73. (c) Angling is 'activity of catching fish'.
74. (a) Bloat means 'to become swollen with fluid or gas'.
75. (b) Incarcerate means 'to imprison or confine'.
76. (c) Roughed out is a phrasal verb means 'to draw a rough draft'. So, 'drew a quick plan' is its synonym.
77. (b) Abyss means 'a deep pit'.
78. (a) Audacity means the rashness or brashness to do something. So, 'courage' is its synonym.
79. (b) Frenetic means lots of unsystematic activities. So, 'hurried' is the right choice.
80. (b) Copious means abundant or plentiful. So, 'exhaustive' is its synonym.
81. (b) Impervious means not able to be influenced, hurt or damaged. So, 'unaffected' is its synonym.
82. (a) 'Elicit' and 'Evoke' mean the same i.e. 'to cause a particular response to happen'.
83. (b) Lucrative and 'profitable' both mean the same, i.e. 'attractive and full of profit'.
84. (b) Mendicant means a beggar. So, option (b) is the correct answer.
85. (c) Rapacious is synonymous with 'greedy'.
86. (d) Desecrate means 'treating with violent disrespect'.
87. (d) The meaning of 'Prolific' is 'producing much fruit and foilage'.
88. (a) Getting peevish means 'to get irritated'.
89. (b) Pernicious means 'harmful'.
90. (b) Heckle means 'to interrupt a public speaker with derisive or aggressive comments or abuse'.
91. (c) Imprecation means 'a curse'.
92. (a) Trilling is a 'quavering or vibratory sound'.
93. (c) Pantisocracy is a form of utopian social organisation in which all are equal in social position and responsibility.
94. (b) Shivel means wrinkle or contract. So, out of the given options 'shrunk' is its synonym.
95. (d) Extrude means 'to force out'.
96. (c) The phrase put down means 'to kill'.
97. (a) Conferred means 'granted'.
98. (a) Swamped means to cover a place or thing with large amount of water. So, 'flood' is its synonym.
99. (b) Consort is 'to spend a lot of time in the company of a particular group of people, especially people whose character is not approved of'.
100. (c) 'Deport' is the synonym of Banish.
101. (a) An exponent is a 'person who supports an idea or belief or performs an activity'.
102. (a) Judder is to 'shake violently'.
103. (d) The phrase stomp on means 'to defeat someone'.
104. (c) The idiom kick the bucket means 'to die'.
105. (b) Congruent means 'similar to'.
106. (d) Deference stands 'for respect and politeness'.
107. (a) 'A quick and clever remark' is called a Riposte.
108. (d) 'Indigestion' is related to Dyspepsia.
109. (a) 'An escape from a bad situation' is called as Reprieve.
110. (c) Recalcitrant means 'unwilling to obey'.
111. (d) Benign stands for 'pleasant and kind'.
112. (a) Harried means 'anxious or worried' because you have too many things to do.
113. (a) Eschew means to 'give up'.
114. (c) Paradigm is a 'model of something, or a very clear and typical example of something'.
115. (b) Subsume is to 'include something or someone as part of a larger group'.
116. (d) Soporific means 'tending to induce drowsiness or sleep'.
117. (c) Allegiance means 'loyalty or commitment to a superior or to a group or cause'.
118. (d) Salutory means having a good or helpful result especially after something unpleasant has happened. So, 'beneficial' is its synonym.
119. (b) Evoked means to cause a particular reaction or response to happen. So, 'called for' is its synonym.

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-2016)

1. (b) Meaning of Authentic is conforming to fact and therefore worthy of trust, reliance or belief. Its synonym from the given options is 'Genuine'.
2. (d) Boast means to speak of (one's own achievements possessions etc) arrogantly adding things that may be false. 'Brag' is also similar in meaning to it.
3. (b) Meaning of Fictitious—not genuine or authentic; assumed; false. From the options, option (b) is the best option as conduct can be imaginary.
4. (d) 'Genocide' is the deliberate killing of a large number of people.
5. (d) Meaning of Executioner – An official in charge of carrying out the death sentence passed upon a condemned person.
6. (c) 'First speech' is called as Maiden Speech.
7. (a) Meaning of Interfere – To be or create a hindrance or obstacle. So, 'meddle' is its synonym.
8. (a) Meaning of Tedious – 'Tiresome' by reason of length, slowness or dullness; boring.
9. (c) Meaning of Takes after and 'resemble' is to look same in appearance, temperament or character.
10. (d) Ill-favour means repulsive or unattractive in appearance.
11. (b) Homage means 'to pay tribute'.
12. (a) Clue means something that serves to guide or direct in the solution of a problem or mystery. So, 'hint' is its synonym.
13. (a) Amazement is a 'state of extreme surprise or wonder or astonishment'. As per the sentence, option (a) would be its synonym.
14. (a) Consistency is a 'harmonious uniformity or agreement or constancy among things or parts or events'. So, option (a) is the right choice.
15. (c) Both electrifying and exciting mean 'causing a surge of excitement'.
16. (b) Refrain means to keep or prevent oneself from doing or saying something. It is synonymous with 'desist'.
17. (a) Merit as a verb means to earn or to deserve. So, 'deserved' is the correct option as its synonym.
18. (a) Prohibit means to stop something from being done or used especially by law. 'Forbid' is most similar in meaning to it.
19. (b) Dubious means not certain and slightly suspicious about something. Hence, 'doubtful' is its synonym.
20. (d) Eccentric means considered by other people to be strange or unusual. Out of the given alternatives 'unconventional' is most similar in meaning to it.
21. (b) Contradict means deny the truth of a statement by asserting the opposite. Hence, 'deny emphatically' is its synonym.
22. (a) Give up means to stop trying to do something. Out of the given alternatives 'abandon' is most similar in meaning to it.
23. (d) Specific means detailed and exact. Hence, 'precise' is its synonym.
24. (b) Eradicate means to get rid of something especially something bad. 'Remove' also means the same.
25. (c) Probable means 'likely to happen or to be true'.
26. (b) Adhere means to stick firmly to something. 'Give allegiance' also has the same meaning.
27. (a) Infer means to reach an opinion or decide that something is true on the basis of information that is available. Hence, 'conclude' is its synonym here.
28. (d) Hesitate means to be worried about doing something especially because you are not sure that it is right or appropriate. Hence, 'unable to decide quickly' is its correct synonym.
29. (b) Explicit means said, done or shown in an open or direct way. Hence, 'plainly stated' is the right option.
30. (a) 'Sufficient' and 'adequate' both mean 'enough for a particular purpose'.
31. (c) Repress means to try not to show an emotion or a feeling. 'Curb' is most similar in meaning to it.
32. (c) 'Vindictive and revengeful' both have the same meaning i.e. 'disposed to seek revenge'.
33. (c) Painstaking means one who is ready to take pain. Hence, 'taking risk' is the right choice.
34. (d) Substantial means large in amount. The same is meant by 'significant'.
35. (b) Indolent means slothful or idle. The same is meant by 'lazy'.
36. (d) Vehemently means caused by strong feelings. The same is meant by 'forcefully'.
37. (d) Oblivious means not conscious or aware of. The same is meant by 'unaware'.
38. (a) Feigned means behaved in a particular way in order to make other people believe something that is not true. The same is meant by 'pretended'.
39. (a) Penury means the state of being poor. The same is meant by 'poverty'.
40. (b) Affectation means not genuine or natural. The same is meant by 'artificiality'.
41. (c) Stifle means to suffocate or suppress. The same is meant by 'smother'.
42. (a) Beseech means to ask earnestly. 'Request' means the same.
43. (b) Stalemate means a situation in which neither side can make any progress. 'Deadlock' also means the same.
44. (d) Impromptu means without being prepared or unrehearsed. 'Offhand' is its synonym.
45. (a) Lucrative means that which yields great profit. 'Profitable' also means the same.
46. (a) Forthright means saying exactly what a person thinks, in a clear and direct way. 'Honest and outspoken' also mean the same.
47. (c) Reprimand means to tell somebody officially that he/she has done something wrong. 'Rebuke' means 'to speak angrily to somebody because he/she has done something wrong'.

48. (b) Punctilious means showing great attention to detail or correct behaviour. So, 'careful' is its synonym.
49. (d) Discreet means careful in what one says and does so as not to cause embarrassment or difficulty for somebody. 'Prudent' means 'sensible and careful when making judgements and decisions'.
50. (c) Momentous means having great importance. 'Very important' implies the same.
51. (d) Portend means to give warning of. 'Foreshadow' also means 'be a warning or indication of a future event'.
52. (b) Odium means general dislike or disapproval. 'Hatred' also means the same.
53. (b) Sterling means 'genuine or reliable' when used for a person.
54. (b) Corporal punishment means 'physical punishment'.
55. (a) Mitigate means 'to lessen'.
56. (a) Idiosyncrasies are 'peculiar habits'.
57. (b) Perfunctory means done quickly, without taking care or interest. So, 'superficial' is its synonym.
58. (a) Grave means 'serious'.
59. (d) Empirical means 'based on observation or experience'. Hence, option (d) is its synonym.
60. (b) Ordnance refers to 'arms and ammunition'.
61. (d) A Sycophant means 'a flatterer'.
62. (a) Veracity means 'truth'.
63. (c) Aspire means longing. So, 'hope for' is its correct synonym.
64. (c) Sequel means follow up. So, 'continuation' is its correct synonym.
65. (a) Perpetual means lasting. So, 'constant' is its correct synonym which means 'continual'.
66. (d) Assent means common view. So, 'agreement' is its correct synonym.
67. (b) Defiance means disregard. So, 'disobedience' is its correct synonym.
68. (b) Hostility means unfriendliness or opposition. So, 'enmity' is its synonym.
69. (c) Indifferent means uninterested. So, 'unconcerned' is its correct synonym.
70. (a) Condemn means blame. So, 'censure' is its correct synonym which means 'belittle'.
71. (c) 'Confident and sure' are synonyms which mean 'being definite'.
72. (c) Defect means imperfection. So, 'shortcoming' is its perfect synonym.
73. (a) 'Jealous and envious' are synonyms as they mean 'unhappy and angry because someone has something that you want'.
74. (a) Trip means travelling. So, 'journey' is its correct synonym.
75. (a) Both 'deplore and condemn' have the same meaning. They are synonymous.
76. (a) Both 'motivation and persuade' have the same meaning, i.e. 'the act of motivating'.
77. (a) Both 'residue and remainder' have the same meaning, i.e. 'whatever left'.
78. (c) Perpetual means 'never ending'.
79. (d) Both 'assent and agree' have the same meaning, i.e. 'being in agreement'.
80. (d) Both 'defiance and resistance' have the same meaning, i.e. 'bold disobedience'.
81. (a) Both 'emancipate and liberate' have the same meaning, i.e. 'to set free'.
82. (c) Both 'hostility and enmity' have the same meaning, i.e. 'ill will'.
83. (c) Both 'mark down and reduce' have the same meaning i.e. 'to lessen'.
84. (b) Both 'effrontery and impudence' have the same meaning as 'insolent or impertinent behaviour'.
85. (a) Both 'devastating and terrible' mean the same, i.e. 'causing severe distress or grief'.
86. (d) Both 'exhaustive and thorough' have the same meaning i.e. 'complete'.
87. (b) Both 'laying up and accumulating' have the same meaning, i.e. 'build up'.
88. (b) Both 'might and strength' mean the same, i.e. 'impressive power'.
89. (a) 'Dwells and lives' have the same meaning which means 'to live'.
90. (c) Both 'respond and answer' have the same meaning which means 'say something in reply'.
91. (a) Both 'mundane and worldly' mean the same, i.e. 'of this earthly world rather than a heavenly or spiritual one'.
92. (c) Both 'dangerous and perilous' have the same meaning, i.e. 'likely to cause harm or injury'.
93. (d) Both 'unlimited and infinite' mean the same, i.e. 'without any limit'.
94. (b) Both 'dictator and autocrat' mean the same, i.e. 'a ruler with total power over a country'.
95. (a) Both 'annual and yearly' have the same meaning as 'occurring once every year'.
96. (c) Both 'fanatic and bigot' mean the same, i.e. 'a person who has very extreme beliefs'.
97. (a) Both 'trivial and unimportant' have the same meaning which means 'of little value or importance'.
98. (c) Both 'ambiguous and vague' have the same meaning, i.e. 'not clear'.
99. (a) Both 'elucidate and clarify' have the same meaning which means 'to explain something or make something clear'.
100. (a) Both 'monotonous and dreary' have the same meaning which means 'uninteresting or dull'.
101. (b) Both 'kindle and excite' have the same meaning which means 'become impassioned'.
102. (d) Both 'palatial and magnificent' have the same meaning which means 'very large and impressive'.
103. (a) Both 'tactful and diplomatic' have the same meaning which means 'having or showing skill and sensitivity in dealing with others or with difficult issues'.
104. (b) Both 'voracious and insatiable' have the same meaning 'needing a lot of something to be satisfied'.
105. (d) Both 'stricture and censure' have the same meaning which means 'a remark or comment, especially an adverse criticism'.
106. (a) Both 'obeisance and homage' have the same meaning, i.e. 'to express deep respect'.

04

ANTONYMS

Generally, 8-10 questions are asked on antonyms in the CDS exam. The questions can be asked in a direct format or in a sentence format. The candidate is expected to have a good vocabulary to solve these questions.



An **Antonym** is a word that is directly opposite in meaning to a given word.
e.g. The word 'Fresh' has its antonym as 'Stale'.

Questions on antonyms are asked directly or in a sentence format

1. Direct Format

In this format a word is given and out of the given four options, a word is to be selected which is opposite in meaning to the given word.

e.g. Which of the given word is **opposite** in meaning to the word provided?

DEAD

- (a) Moving (b) Life (c) Alive (d) Deceased

Explanation (c) 'Dead' means no longer alive. To find the antonym of dead, we have to consider its opposite meaning i.e. 'not dead' or 'living'. 'Alive' means 'living or not dead'. So, option (c) is the correct choice.

2. Sentence Format

In this format one word of a sentence is highlighted and out of the given four options, a word is to be selected which is opposite in meaning to that of the highlighted word.

e.g. Which of the given words is the **antonym** of the word written in capital letters?

Shyam ran QUICKLY to catch the bus.

- (a) Weakly (b) Hurriedly (c) Manly (d) Slowly

Explanation (d) Considering the given options, antonym of 'quickly' is 'slowly'. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.



CHECK YOUR VOCABULARY

FIND THE ANTONYM OF GIVEN WORDS

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-75) Each of the following items consists of a sentence followed by four words or group of words. Select the **antonym** of the word (occurring in the sentence in capital letters) as per the context.

1. DETAIN

- (a) Release (b) Silence
(c) Forget (d) Prosper

2. FAMOUS

- (a) Boring (b) Poor
(c) Obscure (d) Untalented

3. COLOSSAL

- (a) Easy (b) Tiny
(c) Graceful (d) Fool

4. FLUID

- (a) Solid (b) Liquid
(c) Afraid (d) Decent

5. CONTINUE

- (a) Curve (b) Argue
(c) Carry (d) Pause

6. LABOUR

- (a) Amuse (b) Cat
(c) Rest (d) Strive

7. BRAWNY

- (a) Swift (b) Weak
(c) Strong (d) Pale

8. FICKLE

- (a) Steady (b) Kind
(c) Please (d) Finagle

9. INEPT

- (a) Clumsy (b) Infer
(c) Competent (d) Foolish

10. PIVOTAL

- (a) Turning (b) Wavy
(c) Unimportant (d) Clear

11. CURSED

- (a) Swore (b) Pious
(c) Unfortunate (d) Lucky

12. CANDID

- (a) Unkind (b) Blunt
(c) Valid (d) Dishonest

13. FLAUNT

- (a) Regard (b) Sink
(c) Hide (d) Propose

14. HEAL

- (a) Sew (b) Foot
(c) Good (d) Maim

15. PACIFY

- (a) Excite (b) Land
(c) Coddle (d) Unhand

16. SULLEN

- (a) Dirty (b) Cheerful
(c) Clean (d) Risen

17. ASSURE

- (a) Alarm (b) Reassure
(c) Quiet (d) Unsure

18. FALLACIOUS

- (a) Perfect (b) Truthful
(c) Accidental (d) Disarming

19. GUMPTION

- (a) Seriousness (b) Apathy
(c) Levity (d) Despair

20. ECSTASY

- (a) Gate (b) Agony
(c) Languor (d) Fatigue

21. ASTUTE

- (a) Distraught (b) Careful
(c) Generous (d) Foolish

22. WINSOME

- (a) Dour (b) Attractive
(c) Mysterious (d) Clever

23. DROLL

- (a) Forget (b) Charm
(c) Sedate (d) Absurd

24. ENIGMATIC

- (a) Healthy (b) Watchful
(c) Disastrous (d) Obvious

25. OBTUSE

- (a) Slim (b) Acute
(c) Opaque (d) Thick

26. OBSEQUIOUS

- (a) Clear (b) Clever
(c) Domineering (d) Dandified

27. DOLEFUL

- (a) Empty (b) Rich
(c) Witty (d) Elated

28. WANTON

- (a) Merciful (b) Repast
(c) Brilliant (d) Vicious

29. BANAL

- (a) Sincere (b) Wealthy
(c) Extraordinary (d) Trustworthy

30. LUGUBRIOUS

- (a) Quick (b) Cheerful
(c) Salubrious (d) Dry

31. PERSPICACIOUS

- (a) Calm (b) Easy
(c) Dull (d) Winsome

32. ELAN

- (a) Inelegance (b) Stupidity
(c) Obscure (d) Despair

33. RECONDITE

- (a) Manifest (b) Flexible
(c) Provident (d) Sociable

34. GAINSAY

- (a) Regret (b) Own
(c) Prudent (d) Prude

35. EFFLUVIUM

- (a) Land (b) Essential
(c) Fragrance (d) Solid

36. PARSIMONY

- (a) Generosity (b) Sinfulness
(c) Verbosity (d) Tenderness

37. TRUCULENT

- (a) Faltering (b) Gentle
(c) Facile (d) Submissive

38. SPURIOUS

- (a) Disingenuous (b) Thoughtless
(c) Placid (d) Genuine

39. WELTER

- (a) Order (b) Freeze
(c) Patron (d) Sustain

40. ECLAT

- (a) Apathy (b) Dullness
(c) Silence (d) Disinterest

41. PESSIMISTIC

- (a) Indifferent (b) Ascetic
(c) Helpful (d) Hopeful

42. ANALOGOUS

- (a) Similar
(b) Uncritical
(c) Disproportionate
(d) Dissimilar

43. EVIDENT

- (a) Unnoticeable (b) Observed
(c) Seen (d) Calculated

44. THICK SKINNED

- (a) Insensitive (b) Sensitive
(c) Resolute (d) Different

45. ELEGANCE

- (a) Balance (b) Savagery
(c) Dullness (d) Politeness